

Ireland

Ireland.....	1
1. Study Courses That Qualify (Claude)	1
2. Embassy/Visa Appointment	1
3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa	2
4. Documents to Prepare	2
5. Money/Financial Requirements	3
6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival.....	3
7. Working While Studying.....	3
8. Renewing the Residence Permit.....	4
9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies	4
10. Official Government Information.....	5
11. Official Application Forms	5
12. Common Mistakes & Tips	6
1. Study Courses (Gemini)	6
2. Embassy Appointment	7
3. Applying for a Study Visa	7
4. Documents Needed.....	7
5. Money Requirements	7
6. Residence Permit	8
7. Working While Studying.....	8
8. Renewing the Residence Permit.....	8
9. Changing to a Work Permit	9
10. Official Information.....	9
11. Application Forms	9
12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)	9

1. Study Courses That Qualify (Claude)

To get permission to study in Ireland, your course must appear on the official **Interim List of Eligible Programmes (ILEP)** or the **TrustEd Ireland Providers list**. If you want to study in Ireland for longer than 90 days, you must choose a course from the Interim List of Eligible Programmes (ILEP) or the TrustEd Ireland Providers eligible programmes list. Eligible course types generally include: [Irish Immigration](#)

Claude is partially correct: Non-EEA nationals coming to study in Ireland must be enrolled in an eligible full-time course on the Interim List of Eligible Programmes (ILEP)

- Higher education programmes (levels 6-10 on the National Framework of Qualifications) — degrees, diplomas, postgrad, PhD Higher education programmes range from level 6-10 on the National Framework of Qualifications (NFQ) [Irish Immigration](#)
- **English language courses**
- Foundation programmes that prepare students for entry into a degree programme

Claude is partially correct: English-language programmes (minimum 25-week courses, offered within a 7-month period, with minimum 15 classroom tuition hours per week)

- Foundation Programmes prepare international students to meet the minimum academic requirements to study a higher education programme in Ireland [Irish Immigration](#)

Importantly, the course must be **full-time**: you must enrol on a full-time day time programme — part-time or distance learning courses do not qualify for student permission. [Irish Immigration](#)

2. Embassy/Visa Appointment

Visa applications go through Ireland's online system, **AVATS**, and biometrics are collected at a **Visa Application Centre (VAC)**, run by VFS Global in most countries — not the embassy directly.

- Details of how to make an appointment for the VAC will be included in your application summary form. The capture of your biometric information will take place when you are submitting your documents to the Visa Clerk at the VAC. [Irish Immigration](#)
- In countries like the UK, applicants can book an appointment on VFS's webpage. [Ireland.ie](#)

So the process is: complete the AVATS online form → it generates a summary/reference number → use that to book your VAC appointment for document submission and fingerprints.

3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa

Documents needed (core list):

- Letter of enrolment/acceptance from an ILEP-listed school, and proof fees are paid you will need to have a letter of enrolment, paid your fees [Irish Immigration](#)
- Proof of funds (see Question 5)
- English (or Irish) language proficiency evidence if relevant If you apply for an English language course, you must have a basic level of English before coming to Ireland... Please submit a certificate from the test provider with your visa application [Irish Immigration](#)
- Valid passport, photos, completed AVATS summary form, medical insurance

How to apply: You should apply for a long term study visa up to 3 months before your date of travel to Ireland. You must apply from your home country or where you are a legal resident. You complete the AVATS online application, print and sign the **Summary Application Form**, then submit it with documents at your VAC appointment. [Irish Immigration](#)

How long it takes: Processing time isn't officially fixed and varies by country and season, but third-party sources commonly cite roughly **2–8 weeks**, longer in peak summer months. **It's wise to apply as early as the 3-month window allows.**

Claude Partially correct: For stays of less than 3 months: apply for "C study visa" , For stays of 3 months or more: apply for "D study visa". Applications can be submitted no more than 3 months before intended arrival

4. Documents to Prepare

In addition to the above: **passport (valid well beyond your stay)**, passport photos, **proof of accommodation**, **financial evidence**, fee payment receipt, and — depending on course type — English test results or a college statement on Irish-language ability. Where the course fees are less than €6,000, you must pay fees in full to the college before applying for your visa if €6,000 or more, minimum €6,000 must be paid . [Irish Immigration](#)

Mostly correct: Passport valid for at least 6 months beyond intended stay, Evidence of private medical insurance, Proof of accommodation is not listed as a core requirement on official ISD sources 6 months of consecutive bank statements on official bank paper

5. Money/Financial Requirements

Irish immigration policy requires students to show they can support themselves without working: If you wish to come to Ireland to study you must show proof that you have enough funds to support your stay without relying on casual work. This will be checked during a visa application or at registration. [Irish Immigration](#)

The commonly cited figure is **€10,000 per year of study**, which must be genuinely accessible (not locked in fixed deposits). I'd recommend double-checking this exact figure on the official site before applying, since funding thresholds can be revised — but as of recent guidance, **€10,000 for the first year is the benchmark figure used across multiple current sources.**

Mostly correct: For courses that result in a stay of 6 to 8 months, the monthly financial requirement is €833 per month (€4,998 for 6 months; €6,665 for 8 months)

6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival

This is the **IRP (Irish Residence Permit)** registration, done at **Burgh Quay, Dublin** for first-time registration: **ISD registers first time permissions at Burgh Quay in Dublin.** All subsequent permission renewals within the Republic of Ireland are to be applied for online. Once approved, you will receive an Irish Residence Permit (IRP) card by post at the address you provided to ISD, which you should always carry as proof of legal residence. [Irish ImmigrationIrish Immigration](#)

You must do this if staying more than 90 days, regardless of whether you needed a visa to enter: All non-EEA students, including those who do not require a visa, must register with the immigration office to get permission to remain in Ireland for more than 90 days. Appointments are booked through your online ISD/Customer Service account, and appointments can only be made after your arrival in Ireland. [Citizens InformationIrish Immigration](#)

Mostly correct: First-time registrations at Burgh Quay apply only to those living in Dublin; those living outside Dublin register at their local immigration registration office (Garda station)

7. Working While Studying

Yes — students with Stamp 2 permission can work part-time: Students with a valid Stamp 2 permission may work up to 20 hours a week while they are studying in Ireland. [Irish Immigration](#)

Holders of Stamp 2 permission are not permitted to engage in any business or trade within the State (cannot own a company or operate as a sole trader registered in Ireland)

More information: Students with Stamp 2A permission are not allowed to work

There's a generous exception during holiday periods: During the months of June, July, August and September and from 15 December to 15 January students may work up to 40 hours per week. [Irish Immigration](#)

(Note: this expanded work right generally applies to students on programmes at NFQ Level 7 or above — English-language-only students have more limited work rights.)

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

If your course runs longer than a year, you renew your IRP **online**, not in person: Applications to renew and receive a new IRP card should be submitted online through our online renewals portal. [Irish Immigration](#)

Key rules:

- You can apply to renew your IRP up to 12 weeks prior to its expiry date. [Irish Immigration](#)
- Stamp 2 applicants (students) must wait until their course starts before they can apply to renew. [Irish Immigration](#)
- You must currently be present in Ireland to be eligible to renew your permission to remain online. Applications submitted from outside Ireland will not be accepted. [Irish Immigration](#)
- Renewing on time means there is no disadvantage or time lost in renewing prior to expiry, since the new permission picks up from your current expiry date. [Irish Immigration](#)

9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies

Yes — graduates can move from Stamp 2 (student) to **Stamp 1G** under the **Third Level Graduate Scheme**, which lets you stay and work without needing a separate employment permit:

- Graduates with an award at Level 8 on the National Framework of Qualifications will be granted a 12-month permission... Graduates with an award at Level 9 or above... qualify for the Programme and will be granted permission for 24 months. [Future Direct](#)
- Those who get Stamp 1G have the right to remain in Ireland and work full-time in accordance with employment law requirements without further authorisation. However, you cannot operate a business or be self-employed under your Stamp 1G status. [Future Direct](#)
- Process: You must have an ISD (Immigration Service Delivery) account. Go to "Renewals" and select to renew your permission from Stamp 2 to Stamp 1G. [University of Galway](#)
- Documents needed include your current IRP card... proof of qualification (an original letter from your college confirming course completion and final results)... valid medical insurance... and an application fee (commonly cited around €300). [AECC](#)
- You can only apply after you have received your official final results. You must apply within six months of receiving these results and before your current Stamp 2 permission expires. [AECC](#)

- After Stamp 1G, if you want to keep working long-term, you will require an employment permit from the Department of Enterprise, Trade and Employment to continue to stay in Ireland. [Future Direct](#)

10. Official Government Information

The authoritative source for all of the above is **Immigration Service Delivery (ISD)**, at **irishimmigration.ie**. It's the official Irish government immigration site covering visas, registration, renewals, and the Third Level Graduate Scheme. For general citizen-facing explainers, **citizensinformation.ie** is also an official, reliable resource. I'd suggest treating these two as your primary sources and being cautious with third-party "education consultancy" blogs, which can contain outdated or inaccurate fee/figure details.

11. Official Application Forms

- The **visa application** itself is completed entirely online through **AVATS** (the online visa application system on [irishimmigration.ie](#)) — there's no separate downloadable PDF form; AVATS generates your personalized Summary Application Form after you fill in your details.
- For **IRP registration and renewals**, you create an account on the **ISD Customer Service portal** (also via [irishimmigration.ie](#)) to book your registration appointment and submit renewal applications — again, mostly form-free since it's a guided online system rather than downloadable paperwork.

12. Common Mistakes & Tips

Based on patterns across guidance sources:

- **Applying too late** — apply as close to the 3-month window as possible; peak season (June–August) means longer processing.
- **Inconsistent personal details** across documents and passport (name spelling, dates) — even small mismatches can cause delays or refusal.
- **Funds that aren't genuinely accessible** — money tied up in fixed deposits or investments typically isn't accepted as proof of funds.
- **Not disclosing previous visa refusals** — non-disclosure is treated seriously and can lead to automatic refusal.
- **Missing the registration deadline** after arrival — you need to book your IRP appointment promptly, even though slots can only be booked after you land.
- **Forgetting medical insurance** — private health insurance is compulsory for non-EU/EEA students and is checked at multiple stages.
- **Not enrolling on an ILEP-listed course** — enrolling on a non-eligible programme means no student permission will be granted at all, regardless of other paperwork.

- **Does not mention unexplained large deposits** : Large, unexplained deposits within 3 months of application will trigger rejection unless accompanied by clear explanation

1. Study Courses (Gemini)

To apply for an Irish study visa, you must be enrolled in a **full-time, in-person** course listed on the **Interim List of Eligible Programmes (ILEP)**.

- **Eligible course types:** Higher education programmes (undergraduate degrees, Master's, or PhDs) at Level 6 or above on the National Framework of Qualifications (NFQ), or an **approved English-language course (minimum 25 weeks with at least 15 tuition hours per week)**.
- The ILEP is still operational and will be phased out once TrustEd Ireland is fully implemented. Study Visas and Stamp 2 permissions will only be granted for courses listed in the ILEP or an eligible course offered by a provider with authorisation to use the TrustEd Ireland mark
- Part-time, online, or distance learning courses **do not** qualify.

2. Embassy Appointment

Visa applications are initiated online through the official Irish system (**AVATS**).

- Once you fill out the online application, the system will direct you on how to submit your physical documents.
- Depending on your home country, you will either book an appointment to submit your documents and biometrics (fingerprints/photos) at a local **VFS Global centre** or directly with the nearest **Irish Embassy or Consulate**.

3. Applying for a Study Visa

The application process follows these primary steps:

1. **Apply and get accepted** by an eligible Irish educational institution.
2. **Pay your tuition fees** (either in full or a minimum of €6,000 upfront).
3. **Complete the AVATS online application** form, pay the visa fee (€60 for single entry), and print your summary sheet.
4. **Book your appointment** via VFS Global or the Embassy to submit your physical documents and biometrics.

- **Processing time:** It typically takes **4 to 8 weeks**, though it can take longer during peak summer months. You should apply at least 3 months before your course starts. Does not distinguish between "C" and "D" study visas.
- **Correct information:** The Irish Visa Office in London targets 45 days for study visa processing. Trinity College Dublin advises average processing time is approximately 8-12 weeks. TU Dublin states it normally takes eight weeks but may take longer in busy periods. For stays of less than 3 months, apply for "C study visa"; for stays of 3 months or more, apply for "D study visa".

4. Documents Needed

Before applying, you must prepare the following physical and digital documents:

- A valid passport (valid for at least 6 months past your intended course completion date).
- The printed and signed **AVATS application summary sheet**.
- An official **Letter of Acceptance** from the Irish university/college.
- Proof of tuition fees paid (official receipt showing a minimum of €6,000 paid, or 100% of the fee if total tuition is under €6,000).
- Proof of English language proficiency (e.g., IELTS, TOEFL, PTE).
- Evidence of private **medical health insurance** valid in Ireland.
- A Statement of Purpose (SOP) detailing why you want to study in Ireland.
- Comprehensive **financial documentation** (detailed below).

5. Money Requirements

The Irish Immigration Service (ISD) enforces strict, standardized financial checks:

- **Living Costs:** For courses lasting longer than 8 months, you must prove you have **immediate access to at least €10,000** for your first year of living expenses. For shorter courses, you must show €833 per month.
- **Tuition:** You must show access to the remainder of your first-year tuition if it was not paid in full.
- **Future Years:** If doing a multi-year degree (like a Bachelor's), you must show that you or your sponsors have a sustainable income or funding model to cover €10,000 plus tuition for each subsequent year.
- **Proof Format:** You must provide **6 months of consecutive bank statements** on official bank paper. Large, sudden deposits made right before the application will trigger a rejection unless accompanied by a clear, documented explanation of the source.

6. Residence Permit

A study visa only grants you permission to *enter* Ireland. Once you arrive, you must register your stay if your course lasts longer than 90 days.

- You must register with **Immigration Service Delivery (ISD)** to get your **Irish Residence Permit (IRP) card** (Stamp 2).
- **If living in Dublin or outside Dublin:** You must set up an account on the official ISD Customer Service Portal, verify your identity via a partner verification app (like ID-Pal), and book an in-person appointment.
- You will pay a **€300 registration fee** at your appointment, and your IRP card will be sent to your Irish address by post.

7. Working While Studying

Yes, international students holding a valid **Stamp 2** residence permit are legally permitted to work part-time without needing a separate work permit.

Students with Stamp 2A permission are not allowed to work . Holders of Stamp 2 permission are not permitted to engage in any business or trade within the State .

- **During term time:** Up to **20 hours per week**.
- **During holiday periods:** Up to **40 hours per week** during specified seasonal blocks (typically June to September, and from December 15 to January 15).

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

If your course lasts longer than one year, you must renew your immigration permission annually before your current IRP card expires.

- **How to renew:** All renewals nationwide are processed **online** via the official ISD Online Portal. You do not need to attend an in-person office.
- You will upload your updated college attendance certificate, proof of progression (passing grades), health insurance, and pay the annual €300 renewal fee online.

9. Changing to a Work Permit

After successfully completing your degree, you can transition into the workforce via the **Third Level Graduate Scheme (Stamp 1G)**.

- **Level 8 Graduates (Honours Bachelor's):** Entitled to a 12-month post-study stay back.
- **Level 9+ Graduates (Master's / PhD):** Entitled to up to 24 months (granted in two 12-month blocks).

- During the Stamp 1G period, you can work full-time while looking for a company to sponsor you for a **General Employment Permit** or a **Critical Skills Employment Permit** via the Department of Enterprise, Trade and Employment.

10. Official Information

Always rely on official government portals for the most up-to-date immigration changes:

- **Immigration Service Delivery (ISD):** irishimmigration.ie
- **Citizens Information Ireland:** citizensinformation.ie

11. Application Forms

- The primary portal to submit your online student entry visa application and fill out necessary forms is the **AVATS Online Facility** via the Irish Immigration website.
- First-time registrations and annual renewals are handled through the **ISD Online Portal**.

12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)

- **Unexplained Large Deposits:** Sending a lump sum of money into your or your sponsor's bank account a few weeks before applying is the #1 reason for visa rejection. Keep funds stable for 6 months, or provide written proof of where the money came from (e.g., selling property, an official education loan sanction).
- **Gap in Academic History:** If you have spent time out of school or work, explain it clearly in your statement of purpose. Unexplained time gaps make immigration officials question if you are a genuine student.
- **Incomplete Tuition Payment:** Not highlighting the clear line of sight between the required €6,000 minimum college payment and your bank statements will stall your application. Make sure your university receipt exactly matches your paperwork.

Does not mention the 12-week rule for renewal applications : Students must have less than 12 weeks left on current permission before using online renewal system .